Ganesh Sivasankara

MD · DNB · FRCA · FCARCSI

Consultant Anaesthetist and Section Head of Paediatric Anaesthesia
King Faisal Specialist Hospital and Research Centre, Riyadh

ganesh@ganeshsivasankara.com
ganeshsivasankara.com · linkedin.com/in/ganeshsivasankara

Consultant Anaesthetist with twenty-five years in anaesthesia across India, the UK and Saudi Arabia, most of them in paediatric, neonatal and obstetric anaesthesia. Section Head of Paediatric Anaesthesia at KFSHRC since 2024, the department's Medical Quality Director from 2023 to 2025, the residents' Teacher of the Year in 2017, and since 2026 the author of a set of free teaching apps for anaesthetists.

Registration

GMC (UK)	**Full registration and Specialist Register**
CCT	**Certificate of Completion of Training in Anaesthetics, 23 January 2011**
SCFHS	**Saudi Commission for Health Specialties, registered**

Current appointment

Apr 2016 – present

Consultant Anaesthetist

KFSHRC, Riyadh · Department of Anesthesiology

Elective and emergency tertiary paediatric and neonatal anaesthesia, including transplant and oncology, with on-call duties (including the emergency vascular access service every third week) and the supervision of residents and fellows; one of a twelve-person paediatric section.

Adult and paediatric ENT and ophthalmic surgery; oral and maxillofacial, orthopaedic, plastic and cosmetic surgery; obstetrics and gynaecology; neurosurgery; anaesthesia for MRI, angiography, radiotherapy and interventional radiology.

Ultrasound-guided regional anaesthesia: single-shot and continuous peripheral nerve, plexus and central neuraxial blocks.

Leadership and management

Sep 2024 – present
Section Head, Paediatric Anaesthesiology (reappointed 2026)
King Faisal Specialist Hospital and Research Centre

Jan 2023 – Dec 2025
Anaesthesia Medical Quality Director
King Faisal Specialist Hospital and Research Centre

2020 – 2022
Anaesthesia rota coordinator
King Faisal Specialist Hospital and Research Centre

2011 – 2016
Obstetric Anaesthetic Pre-Assessment Clinical Lead
Belfast Health and Social Care Trust

2009 – 2010
Departmental tutor
Ulster Hospital, Dundonald, for Queen's University Belfast

Previous consultant appointments

Sep 2011 – Mar 2016

Consultant Anaesthetist with an interest in obstetric and regional anaesthesia

Belfast HSC Trust, substantive post · Royal Victoria, Musgrave Park and Mater hospitals

Elective and emergency tertiary obstetric anaesthesia with on-call duties and trainee supervision; adult and paediatric ENT and ophthalmic surgery including eye blocks; orthopaedic, plastic and cosmetic surgery.

Jul – Aug 2011

Consultant Anaesthetist (substantive)

South Eastern Health and Social Care Trust · Ulster and Downpatrick hospitals

General, dental and obstetric anaesthesia.

Feb – Jun 2011

Locum Consultant Anaesthetist with an interest in obstetric anaesthesia

Royal Victoria Hospital, Belfast

Obstetric anaesthesia with on-call duties and trainee supervision; ENT, ophthalmic, trauma, emergency, gynaecological and general surgery.

Training posts

Aug 2010 – Jan 2011

Specialist Registrar (SpR 5)

Royal Victoria Hospital, Belfast

Adult and paediatric ENT and ophthalmic surgery, obstetrics; on-call for the level 3 emergency theatres.

Aug 2009 – Aug 2010

Specialist Registrar (SpR 4/5)

Ulster Hospital, Dundonald

Registrar rota in orthopaedic, maxillofacial, general, paediatric and obstetric anaesthesia; departmental tutor.

Aug 2008 – Aug 2009

Specialist Registrar (SpR 4)

Royal Victoria Hospital, Belfast

Clinical fellowship in obstetric anaesthesia, Royal Jubilee Maternity Hospital.

Aug 2006 – Aug 2008

Fixed-term specialist trainee, then Specialist Registrar (ST3)

Royal Victoria and Mater hospitals, Belfast

Aug 2005 – Jul 2006

Fixed-term specialist trainee in anaesthetics

Altnagelvin Hospital, Londonderry

Nov 2004 – Aug 2005

Senior House Officer

Belfast City Hospital

Jan – Oct 2004

Senior Resident (registrar equivalent)

Department of Anaesthesia and Intensive Care, PGIMER, Chandigarh

Jan 2001 – Dec 2003

Junior Resident (SHO equivalent)

Department of Anaesthesia and Intensive Care, PGIMER, Chandigarh

Qualifications

Dec 2006

Final FRCA

Royal College of Anaesthetists, London · first attempt

Sep 2006

Final FCARCSI

College of Anaesthetists, Dublin · first attempt

Jan 2006

Primary FRCA

Royal College of Anaesthetists, London · first attempt

May 2004

DNB Anaesthesiology

National Board of Examinations, New Delhi

2001 – 2003

MD Anaesthesia

Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research (PGIMER), Chandigarh

Thesis on haemostatic alterations with intraoperative hydroxyethyl starch.

1993 – 1999

MBBS

Medical College Trivandrum, University of Kerala, with one year of internship

Teaching

2017

Teacher of the Year

Chosen by the anaesthesia residents, KFSHRC

2016 – present
Supervision and teaching of residents and fellows
Paediatric and neonatal anaesthesia, KFSHRC

2011
Trust mentoring scheme, Level 1 Mentoring Course
Royal Victoria Hospital, Belfast

2009 – 2010
Examination courses, simulation and examining
Queen's University Belfast and the Ulster Hospital
Organised the Final FRCA and FCARCSI examination courses; simulation teaching on the fourth-year Perioperative and Emergency Medicine (POEM) module; OSCE examiner for fourth-year medical students.

Teaching resources and writing

Free apps for anaesthetists, published in 2026; no sign-up, and the sources are listed on each page.

Reading the EEG ganeshsivasankara.com/reading-the-eeg
A course on the anaesthetic EEG for residents, built around a live trace, with a thirty-one-term primer.

Reading the clot ganeshsivasankara.com/reading-the-clot
The TEG and ROTEM trace, normal beside each defect with what to give; drills, and a plot of your own numbers.

Cannulation geometry ganeshsivasankara.com/cannulation-geometry
Insertion angle against catheter length, and what each combination leaves inside the vein.

The magnet ganeshsivasankara.com/the-magnet
MRI safety physics for the anaesthetist in ten cards, the field drawn as iron filings and computed from the magnet.

How the AI you use works ganeshsivasankara.com/how-the-ai-works
A dictionary of the terms behind the AI tools clinicians already use, one card per term.

Before you sign ganeshsivasankara.com/before-you-sign
A three-minute exercise in checking an AI scribe's note from a pre-anaesthesia consultation before signing it.

Spoken Saudi Arabic for anaesthetists ganeshsivasankara.com/spoken-saudi-arabic
102 phrases from the anaesthetic room to recovery, each spoken by a Saudi voice, with listen-and-repeat and a quiz.

The disagreement checker ganeshsivasankara.com/bp-targets · ganeshsivasankara.com/glp1-sglt2
One clinical question put to six AI models, with the spread of answers drawn on one scale. Runs on paediatric blood pressure targets and on GLP-1 agonists and SGLT2 inhibitors before surgery.

Guideline tracker ganeshsivasankara.com/guideline-tracker
What has changed in anaesthesia guidelines over the last two years, with links to the full text.

Writing substack.com/@ganeshsivasankara
Regular posts on LinkedIn on the evidence behind everyday anaesthetic practice, and a newsletter on Substack.

Research

Ongoing
Dexmedetomidine and midazolam premedication in children: phase III trial
King Faisal Specialist Hospital and Research Centre
Principal investigator. Randomised, placebo-controlled and partially double-blinded; manuscript in preparation.

Skills

Paediatric and neonatal anaesthesia (pediatric anesthesia) · Obstetric anaesthesia · Ultrasound-guided regional anaesthesia · Vascular access · Transplant and oncology anaesthesia · Anaesthesia for MRI, angiography and interventional radiology · Quality and patient safety · Clinical leadership · Medical education and simulation · Evidence appraisal · Digital teaching tools built with AI